

Plan International Hong Kong

HR Staff Manual

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1. About Plan International Incorporation (PII) & Plan International Hong Kong (PIHK)

Established in 1937, Plan International is one of the world's leading development organisations specifically focusing on children. Headquartered in the U.K., we are working in 57 developing countries, concentrating on making lasting improvements to quality of life in the areas of education, early childhood development, ending violence, sexual and reproductive health and rights, skills and decent work and young people driving change, with funding from 21 fundraising offices. Plan International is independent, with no religious, political or governmental affiliations.

Plan International Incorporation has a deep connection with Hong Kong as it operated a field office from 1959 to 1973, helping nearly 12,000 local children and their families. The Hong Kong office was re-opened in 2009, giving the Hong Kong community a chance to give back by supporting child development programmes and emergency relief work in Asia, Africa and the Americas. Plan International Hong Kong has extended its work to local community in recent years with a focus on safeguarding children's best interest so children can grow up equally, are being valued and cared for, and free from discrimination, fear or violence.

2. PIHK Values & Behavior

Taking Accountability	1. Take ownership of our actions 2. Keep up to date and act in compliance with local laws and regulations as well as internal policies 3. Keep high integrity and good stewardship of our resources
Working well together	1. Foresee potential obstacles, as well as opportunities, and bring them up to our teammates 2. Be respectful, thankful and helpful to our colleagues, donors and working partners 3. Develop trusting and win-win relationship 4. Communicate clearly and give constructive comments
Striving for excellence	1. Believe in the work we do and strive to produce excellent work that fulfills our PURPOSE and VALUES 2. Exhibit a passion for continuous improvement and innovation 3. Be proactive and agile to the changing environment
Customer orientation	Understand internal and external customers' needs and exceed their expectations

3. Purpose and Use of the Manual

The purpose of this manual is to provide employees with the general HR information about the Organisation, terms and conditions of employment, employee benefits, HR policies and etc. Any terms and conditions of employment not covered, in part or in whole, in this manual will be subject to the provisions of labour legislation in force in Hong Kong.

This manual is applicable to all employees who are/are not employed under a continuous contract with the organisation unless specified. It is for internal use by employees only and all such

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information should be treated in strict confidence. No photocopying, circulation or disclosure in any format of its content to unauthorised parties is allowed.

The organisation reserves the right to change, add, delete or discontinue any of the policies in this manual, as it deems appropriate.

4. Appointment

It is the policy of the organisation to recruit the best-qualified people according to the manpower requirement and planning. The human resources office provides recruitment advice and services to all departments and is responsible for the entire process leading to employment.

4.1 Equal Employment Opportunities

The organisation is an equal opportunity employer. We welcome applicants who meet the respective requirements of the job vacancy. All appointments are based on the candidates' past working experience, competencies and qualifications regardless of their gender, age, race, religion, marital status, sexual orientation or family status.

4.2 Reference and Qualification Check

The human resources office will conduct thorough reference and qualification check on **the final applicants**. All applicants must provide the original certificates of education, testimonials, reference letters of the previous employment. Reference checks will be conducted with the applicants' previous two employers **if applicable**. If the information supplied by applicant is found to be fraudulent, the organisation may deny employment or exercise dismissal action.

4.3 Staff record

The organisation shall collect, maintain, use and dispose of personal data of employee, in accordance with the requirements of the Personal Data (Privacy) Ordinance **and Document and Data Retention and Deletion Policy**.

4.4 Staff Card and Access Card

Employees will be issued a staff card and an access card upon commencement of service with the Organisation. Loss of Staff Card or access card must immediately be reported to the human resources office for cancellation and re-issuance. The staff card and access card are the properties of the organisation and are not transferable. They must be returned to the human resources office on the last working day.

4.5 The Sexual Conviction Record Check (SCRC)

The sexual conviction record check is an administrative scheme to enable organisation to check whether the final candidates/ existing employees have any criminal conviction records. Any offer of employment will be conditional upon and subject to the SCRC checking result. It is also the responsibility of the employee to submit a fresh application once the checking code has expired and to inform human resources office of the valid checking code.

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4.5 Staff Grade

The Staff Grading system of the organisation is as follows:

Grade Category	Positions
Chief Executive Officer	Chief Executive Officer
Director	Director
	Deputy Director
	Assistant Director
Manager	Senior Manager
	Manager
	Assistant Manager
Officer	Senior Officer I
	Senior Officer II
	Officer
	Assistant Officer
Coordinator	Coordinator

5. Probation

A new employee is on probation for a period in accordance with the terms stated in the Contract of Employment. The probation periods of various grades are listed as follows:

Job Grade	Probation Period
Assistant Manager Grade or above	6 Months
Senior Officer I or below	3 Months

Towards the end of the probationary period, the appraisal meeting between the employee, direct supervisor and department head or CEO will provide an opportunity to reflect on the employee's performance and will set work objectives for the coming/ remaining financial year. CEO will make the final endorsement on all the probationary documents.

If the supervisor/ department head consider(s) the employee's performance or working attitude is not satisfactory and a longer period of observation is required, the employee will be requested to undergo an extended probationary period, which is at the discretion of department head and CEO.

If the employee performs unsatisfactorily or is proven or found not suitable for the job, he/ she may be terminated at any time, in accordance with the policy for termination and terms stated in the Contract of Employment.

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6. Transfer

To cope with organisational and/ or operational needs and human resources planning, the organisation reserves the right from time to time with reasonable prior notice to transfer employees or assign employees to another role; or position in the same or other department, as deemed necessary and appropriate, with the employee's consent.

7. Promotion

It is the guiding principle of the organisation to promote from within when it is deemed to be in the best interest of the organisation and employee. The organisation places great importance on the career development of every employee and will review and promote an employee, when there are evidence including, but not limited to the potential and abilities to undertake the next level of the responsibilities and where the circumstances permit.

Supervisors are encouraged to consider employees under their supervision, who may be qualified for promotion. Potential for performance in the higher graded position should be the primary criterion for promotion, rather than the time of employment in the present position or with the organisation.

The considerations of promotion are also subject to the employee work performance, service length in PIHK, potential of taking up the responsibilities in the next level, operational need, the availability of the next level vacancy and the financial capability of the organisation. It will be handled on a case-by-case basis and at the discretion of the management of PIHK.

The nominations for promotion must be initiated by the direct supervisor and department head, approved by CEO and administrated by the human resources office.

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8. Termination of Employment

Either the organisation or the employee may terminate the Contract of Employment by informing the other party in writing. The party terminating the Contract of Employment is required to serve the other party a notice of termination, or payment in lieu of the notice as stipulated in the Contract of Employment.

If an employee has applied for annual leave prior to the submission of resignation and the approved leave falls within the notice period, re-approval from Department Head may be sought aiming for assuring sufficient time for work handover. Any change on the leave application should inform human resources office immediately.

8.1 Notice of Termination

Unless the employment contract specified, the notice of termination of various grades (either by employee or organisation) are as follows:

Job Grade	During the 1 st month of probationary period	The 2 nd and 3 rd month of employment	The 4 th to 6 th month of employment	After the probation
Manager Grade or above	Immediate	7 calendar days	1 month	3 months
Assistant Manager Grade			1 month	2 months
Senior Officer I or below			N/A	1 month

The length of notice to be given by either party in the event of an extended probationary period shall be the same as during in the probation.

8.2 Dismissal

Without prejudice to other rights of the organisation, the organisation may terminate summarily the contract of employment immediately by notice in writing to the employee without any payment in lieu of notice if the employee:

- (i) wilfully disobeys a lawful and reasonable order;
- (ii) misconducts oneself, such conduct being inconsistent with the due and faithful discharge of one's duties;
- (iii) is guilty of fraud or dishonesty; or
- (iv) is habitually neglectful in one's duties.

The organisation is also entitled to dismiss any employee without notice, payment in lieu of notice or compensation on any other ground on which the organisation would be entitled to terminate the contract without notice under the Employment Ordinance.

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8.3 Exit Interview

Exit interviews will be conducted for employees who voluntarily leave the positions through retirement or **voluntary resignation**.

9. Retirement

Employment with the organisation will be terminated upon attaining the retirement age of 65, unless a separate agreement or a new contract of employment is entered with the organisation. The organisation reserves the right to determine a new agreement or contract to be entered with the retired employee and with the retired employee's consent.

10. Working Hours

10.1 Hours of work & Lunch Time

The normal working hours will be 42.5 hours per week (including the 1 hour lunch time). The organisation adopts a flexible working hour system. With the approval of their department head or CEO, who have to ensure sufficient staffing of their department throughout the normal office hours.

Employees are allowed to adhere to one of the following working hours:

- 8:30 am - 5:00 pm; or
 - 9:00 am - 5:30 pm; or
 - 9:30 am - 6:00 pm
- Monday to Friday
- (with one hour for lunch: 12:00 pm – 2:00 pm)

All employee's working hours may be re-scheduled by his/her supervisor(s) to suit the operational needs. Employee may be requested by the organisation to work outside the normal working hour and he/she will agree to work overtime without additional monetary reward unless otherwise agreed or specified in the contract of employment.

“Shift employees” (e.g. Direct Dialogue Team) will work and take the two rest days according to the shift roster. The normal working hours of the Direct Dialogue Team will be 40 hours per week (including the 1 hour lunch time). There will be no lunch for the half-day work **and lunch hour will not be included for any half-day work**.

The above arrangement applies on the normal business operations and hours of work arrangement during the “Work from Home” period will be announced in the separated e-mail announcement.

10.2 Duty on Roster

Employees (In-house Direct Dialogue Team) who are required to work on shift owing to the nature of duties should refer to the direct supervisor/ department head for the shift schedules. Supervisors who are responsible for setting the schedules should inform the employees well in advance of any changes in the duty roster.

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10.3 Flexible Working Hours

Employees (office staff) who have a need to deliver training or perform certain job duties or attend event/ activity outside the normal working hours may apply for the flexible working hours with the prior approval of direct supervisor and department Head or CEO.

10.4 Attendance and Punctuality

All employees are expected to be punctual at all times. An employee who is unable to come to work must inform the supervisor as soon as possible. This will facilitate the supervisor to plan for the coverage of the duties and to minimise interruption to workflow. All employees are required to clock in and out at the beginning and end of each workday. Habitual late attendance is considered as misconduct and will result in disciplinary action.

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11. Compensation and Benefits

The scope of the leave policy applies to all full time employees working at office of PIHK.

11.1 Salary

The basic salary of employee (office staff) is the amount per month set out in the Schedule of the Employment Contract and will be paid in local currency into employee's designated bank account on or about the [25th] day of each calendar month. If the 25th falls on weekend or public holiday, payment will be made on the day prior to that weekend or public holiday respectively. The employees of the In-house Direct Dialogue team, the pay date is last workday of each calendar month. Exceptions to the salary release date that may occur will be communicated accordingly.

For the first three-month salary payment to the newly joined employee, payment will be made by cheque and the cheque will be distributed by Finance and Admin Department on the last working day of the month.

For the final payment to the terminated employee, payment will be made by cheque and human resources office will distribute the cheque to employee not later than seven days after the date of termination or expiry of contract. The employee will have to sign off upon the receipt of the final payment and confirming no other liability due from both parties.

11.2 Discretionary Recognition Payment

Employee may be entitled to receive a discretionary recognition payment subject to the completion and our satisfaction of the individual performance objectives in the previous financial year as agreed by the organisation. The amount of discretionary recognition payment is determined by the Board of the organisation based on the considerations, including but not limited to the organisational performance, financial capability of the organisation, employee performance rating as well as the service length in the previous financial year.

The discretionary recognition payment, if payable, will only be applied to employee who has been working with the organisation for three months or above in the previous financial year and be calculated on a pro rata basis based on the number of days working with the organisation in the previous financial year. The discretionary recognition payment is only payable on or about 31 December every year. If the 31st falls on weekend or public holiday, payment will be made on the day prior to that weekend or public holiday respectively. Exceptions to the release date that may occur will be communicated accordingly.

If the employee's employment is terminated on or prior to 31 December, employee will not be entitled to any discretionary recognition payment, whether in full or on a pro rata basis. Employee leaving the organisation as a result of "Summary Dismissal" as mentioned in Section 8.2 or resigning to avoid dismissal will not be entitled to discretionary recognition payment.

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11.3 Mandatory Provident Fund

- i. Employee will become a member of a registered Mandatory Provident Fund (MPF) Scheme. As a member of the MPF, employees are required to contribute an amount equal to a percentage of their salary per month, which is governed by the Mandatory Provident Fund Scheme Ordinance (MPF Ordinance) and may vary from time to time in accordance with the MPF Ordinance. (The Contribution Rate).
- ii. The organisation is also required to contribute an amount equal to a percentage of employee's salary per month.
- iii. Employees may elect to contribute an additional amount of their salary to the MPF fund within the contribution-related limits applicable under the Hong Kong Mandatory Provident Fund Schemes Ordinance.

11.4 Salary Review

The organisation will review the salary in or about July of each year or more frequent intervals as determined at the absolute discretion of the organisation and any adjustment of the salary shall be based on the considerations including but not limited to the financial capability of the organisation, employee performance and costs of living.

Employees who have successfully completed the probation as at the effective date of the salary review of the financial year, he/she will be entitled to a pro-rata adjustment.

Should an employee tender the resignation prior to the date of the official announcement concerning the salary review, that employee will not be eligible for any salary adjustment even if the adjustments are effective retroactively.

11.5 Confidentiality

It is the organisation's policy that remuneration information is strictly confidential.

11.6 Group Medical Insurance

All eligible employees (eligibility as stipulated in the Contract of Employment) who have completed probation or 3 months' services (Assistant Manager or above employee) in the organisation are eligible to enrol in the medical insurance scheme, which covers out-patient visits and hospitalisation.

The scheme rules and the coverage may change from time to time according to the agreement made between the organisation and the medical scheme provider. Details of the medical benefits are available on the HR server.

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11.7 Rental Reimbursement Scheme

a) Introduction

Under the Rental Reimbursement Scheme, the rental value (RV) of employee's living property will be calculated and included in the employee's Assessable Income, and the actual reimbursement of rent paid to the employee will not be treated as income. In other words, the arrangement will not result in any addition of employee's salary. To understand more about the definition, please visit the Inland Revenue Department website.

b) Objectives

- i. This directive is intended to provide a remuneration package for employees, which is both competitive and attractive by including rental reimbursement benefits in the package, in line with the current industry practice.
- ii. The organisation accepts no responsibility for any tax, penalties or surcharges that may arise in respect of the provision of these benefits through this directive.
- iii. It is intended that the introduction of the directive will incur only minimal additional administration costs for the organisation. The emphasis is on the employee to provide all relevant documentation in a timely and accurate manner.

c) Eligibility

All permanent full time employees will be entitled to receive the benefit, in accordance with this directive. All part-time and contract employees will not be entitled to receive the benefit in accordance with this directive.

d) The Mechanism

- i. Eligible employees will be entitled to the rental reimbursement of up to 40% of the Monthly Notional Salary.
- ii. Eligible expenses will only include rental payments incurred in respect of a period throughout, which the employee was on the active payroll of the organisation. The rental costs must be incurred in respect of the employee's primary residence. All claims must be made during the fiscal year in which the employee occupies the relevant accommodation.
- iii. For the purposes of this scheme, "rental reimbursement" is defined as rent paid by the employee for his/her accommodation, which is reimbursed by the organisation.
- iv. Other expenditure such as commissions paid to letting agent(s), utility charges and car parking fees/car space etc. are not considered as part of the rental costs of the accommodation unless the expenditure is inclusive in the rental charge and stipulated in the tenancy/lease agreement. Rates and management fees are included under rental costs.
- v. The tenancy/lease agreement must either be in the name of the employee or in the joint name of the employee and his/her spouse. Where an employee enters jointly signed tenancy/lease agreement with a non-family member, an apportionment of the rental costs will be made. The employee will be required to make a declaration of the actual proportion of rent, which he/she pays.

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- vi. Rental payments made by the employee, which exceed the amount reimbursed will be treated as the employee's own rental contribution.

e) Application Procedures

- i. Prior to the start of the new remuneration package, the eligible employees must submit a "Rental Reimbursement Application Form" together with the stamped lease and tenancy agreement to the organisation for approval.
- ii. Employee will be circulated with the necessary application forms in March each year, which must be completed and submitted to the human resources office prior to the deadline stated therein. Newly joined employee will be entitled for this scheme after the probation is completed. No late application will be entertained.
- iii. Where the employee is a joint tenant with someone other than his/her spouse, he/she will be required to sign a declaration confirming his/her portion of rent that he/she is responsible for.
- iv. If both husband and wife are employees of the organisation, either the husband or the wife may claim the rent paid and is subject to a maximum of 40% of that individual's total monthly notional salary.

f) Claim procedures

- i. Employees must submit a claim for rental reimbursement together with supporting documents as listed in clause "e ii)" to the organisation no later than **20 March** of the same respective tax year. Claims without the required supporting documents will be declined. Employee will be circulated with the appropriate forms at the beginning of March and employee must return the application within the deadline stated therein.
- ii. When making a claim for rental reimbursement, the employee must provide the following documents (subject to paragraphs "e iv) below) to the organisation:
 - Original receipts in the employee's name for rent; and
 - A completed claim form for rental reimbursement.

The above documentation must be provided no later than **20 March** of the same respective tax year. Claims made either after this date or without full supporting documentation will not be accepted.

- iii. The organisation will check that employee have expended the rental reimbursement for its intended purpose by comparing the rental reimbursement entitlement against rental receipts for the tax year ended 31 March. If the claim is properly substantiated by the supporting documents, the Employer's Return for that tax year will show that employee have been provided with staff quarters by the organisation in the form of Rental Reimbursement.
- iv. Where the lease on the accommodation is in the joint names of the employee and his/her spouse, the employee will be required to sign a declaration confirming whether his/her spouse makes a claim for rental reimbursement to his/her employer.

A DUPLICATE CLAIM FOR THE SAME RENTAL EXPENSE IS NOT ACCEPTABLE.

- v. Employees joining the organisation during the tax year will not be entitled to a claim in respect of rental expenses incurred prior to the date of probation completed.

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- vi. Employees who resign from the organisation or have their employment contract terminated for whatever reason within the tax year should submit the claim forms and original receipts and documents no later than ten days prior to the effective date of resignation/termination.
- vii. Any claims made after submission of the employer's return to the Inland Revenue Department will not be accepted.

g) Change of actual rental expenses during the tax year

Under the following circumstances, the employee has a responsibility to immediately notify the CEO Office in writing:

- If the tenancy agreement expires during the year without renewal/replacement
- If there is any changes in rental expenses, i.e. rent increase / reduction

Upon receipt of such notification, the organisation will take appropriate action to review the rental reimbursement.

h) Others

- i. The organisation reserves the right to accept or reject any individual application and to amend or withdraw the scheme if deemed appropriate. The organisation also reserves the right to review and revise the policy and procedures from time to time, in order to ensure compliance with current Hong Kong legislation and Inland Revenue Department practice.
- ii. The organisation cannot guarantee that the Inland Revenue Department will tax employees in a beneficial way in connection with the rental reimbursement. The organisation accepts no responsibility for any tax, penalties or surcharges that may arise in respect of the provisions of the benefits through this directive.

The Rental reimbursement (Application Form) and Rental reimbursement (Claim Form) are available in the HR server.

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11.8 Breastfeeding Friendly Workplace

This policy applies to all staff working at PIHK, regardless the type of employment.

a) Arrangement details:

- i. Employee will be allowed with the lactation breaks (about two 45-minutes breaks a day) for the expression of breast milk during work hours;
- ii. A designated room will be reserved for such purpose and the CCTV and glass door of the pertinent conference room will be covered to offer a space with privacy;
- iii. Employee concerned can reserve the room for 2 sessions with 45 minutes each daily for such purpose;
- iv. Employee concerned can lock the door when it is in use for the purpose.

b) Application:

Employee is required to send the e-mail request with the expected duration to the department head and HR office prior to the usage for at least 2 weeks. Should colleague need more sessions or more time, please communicate with HR Office for further arrangement.

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11.9 Meal Allowance during Overtime Work

A meal allowance shall be payable to a PIHK office employee, at the rate prescribed by this policy due to **local events on weekend or public holiday** where:

a) Arrangement details:

- i. Meal is not included by the event organiser.
- ii. The employee works for at least 4 hours continuous authorised overtime (eating time included, travel time not included).
- iii. Where the event falls in 12:00nn - 2:00pm for lunch or 7:00pm-9:00pm for dinner.
- iv. The meal allowance rate payable below under this policy will be reviewed when necessary. Meal allowance for lunch and dinner should not be combined claimed.

- **HK\$60 maximum for lunch**
- **HK\$80 maximum for dinner**

b) Approvals

- i. A meal allowance should be pre-approved by CEO.
- ii. A meal allowance is payable in circumstances where the overtime is approved by the Unit Head and CEO and the conditions in Section (a) above are met.
- iii. Staff members who are eligible to claim a meal allowance should lodge their claim for actual expenses with the official invoices/ receipts, in accordance with the normal petty cash claim procedures.

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12 Holiday & Leave

The scope of the leave policy applies to all full time employees working at office of PIHK.

12.1 Public Holidays

Public holidays are determined by the General Holidays Ordinance and other applicable local legislation. All employees are entitled to public holidays, subject to any change in law. Payment in lieu of any unused public holidays is not allowed.

If the employment is terminated before the completion of 3-month service, statutory holidays and public holidays are unpaid. The prepaid salary of statutory holidays and public holidays will be deducted in the final payment.

12.2 Annual Leave

PIHKs' holiday year runs from July 1 to June 30. In each holiday year, the holiday entitlement will be fourteen (14) days, increasing by a day after the completion of the 3 years' service, up to a maximum of eighteen (18) days accrual per year unless the employment contract specified.

Full time employees are entitled to take annual leave after the completion of the stipulated probationary period stated in the employment contract. Leave entitlement accrues starting from the first date of employment.

If annual leaves are left over at the mid year-end and year-end (i.e. December 31 and June 30 respectively), employee is allowed to carry forward up to fourteen (14) days to the next half year. Any untaken annual leave beyond the maximum accumulation of fourteen (14) days at the mid year-end and year-end will be lapsed.

Employees will accrue annual leave according to the following schedule:

Years of Service	Annual Leave Entitlement
1 – 3 Years	14 Days
4 Years	15 Days
5 Years	16 Days
6 Years	17 Days
7 Years or above	18 Days

12.3 Official Plan Hong Kong Holidays

Employees are entitled to four (4) half working days' paid Official Plan Hong Kong Holidays, subject to the decision by the Management. The schedule will be announced at the beginning of each calendar year.

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12.4 Sick Leave

a) Paid Sick leave days accumulation

In accordance with the Employment Ordinance, employee can accumulate paid sickness days after having been employed under a continuous contract. Paid sickness days are accumulated at the rate of

- i. Two (2) paid sickness days for each completed month of the employee's employment during the first 12 months, and
- ii. Four (4) paid sickness days for each completed month of employment thereafter starting from the 2nd year of employment. Paid sickness days can be accumulated throughout the whole employment period, but shall not exceed 120 days at any one time.

b) Paid Sick leave days entitlement

An employee employed under a continuous contract is entitled to the paid sick leave, if the employee has accumulated sufficient number of paid sickness days as mentioned in part a) and a leave application form should be submitted to the human resources office on the following business day accompanied with the medical certificate or attendance certificate issued by a registered medical practitioner.

Employee must inform his/her direct supervisor, Department Head or CEO and “cc” human resources office the illness by 08:00 on the day(s) of absence.

12.5 No-Pay Leave

No-pay leave granted will only be granted in a very special circumstances, i.e. only after employees have exhausted the annual leave and compensation leave (CL) or during the probationary period. The grant of no-pay leave is subject to the discretion and approval of CEO.

In ascertaining the number of no-pay leave, if the request of no-pay leave exceeds 5 consecutive working days, Saturdays, Sundays, and public holidays will be included. The amount will be deducted from the monthly payroll.

12.6 Marriage Leave

As an inclusive organisation, PIHK offers employees including the LGBTQ employees three (3) working days of paid marriage leave after the completion of probationary period. The leave can be taken separately or consecutively, which can be taken within one week prior to and one week after the marriage registration. Employee should be the present staff of PIHK on the day of marriage for this leave entitlement. The leave application should be accompanied with the copy of the marriage certificate (local or oversea).

12.7 Maternity Leave

Paid maternity leave fourteen (14) weeks are granted and paid in accordance with the employment ordinance. In making an application for maternity leave, employee should present a medical certificate issued by a registered medical practitioner specifying the expected date of confinement.

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Employee should request the maternity leave period with the department head and seek approval at least two months prior to the commencement of maternity leave.

With the agreement of the organisation, maternity leave may commence within a period of not less than 2 weeks before or not more than 4 weeks before the expected date of confinement. If the staff member does not exercise her option of, or fails to reach the agreement with the organisation before the commencement date of leave, maternity leave shall commence 4 weeks immediately before the expected date of confinement.

If the confinement takes place later than the expected date, extra days from the expected date to (and including) the actual date will be allowed in addition to the (14) fourteen-week basic entitlement

On the first day of resuming duty, the employee must submit the obstetrician's certificate to HR department via the department head.

12.8 Paternity Leave

All male employees are entitled to five (5) working days of paternity leave upon for each child born. Paternity leave days can be taken separately or consecutively, but must be taken within the period of four weeks prior to the expected date of delivery and 14 weeks following the actual date of the delivery of the child.

In making an application for paternity leave, employee must notify organisation of his intention to take paternity leave at least 3 months before the expected date of the child delivery (exact date of leave not required at this stage); and he must notify his date of paternity leave at least 5 days before the leave.

12.9 Bereavement Leave

After completion of the probationary period, employees (including the LGBTQ employees) are entitled to three (3) working days of bereavement leave for each occasion for the death of an immediate family member. An immediate family member is his/her spouse, child, parent, parent-in-law, sibling, grandparent or grandchild. The leave can be taken separately or consecutively within 3 months after the death of the family member.

12.10 Jury leave

Employees will be given leave to attend court for jury service in Hong Kong and will be paid at their usual salary. Employees should advise their department head and human resources office as soon as they receive the notification for jury duty, and plan their work accordingly to facilitate the smooth running of their particular job functions during their absence from the office to attend the jury duty. Leave for jury service will not be counted against annual leave.

12.11 Menstruation Leave

With the increased concern of woman welfare on menstrual syndromes in HK and the popularity of statutory menstrual leave in several Asian countries, PIHK advocates adopting the menstruation friendly workplace in HK.

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a) Entitlement

All full time female employees and have completed 3 months of service in PIHK.

- Employee can take one (1) day leave in a calendar month, maximum twelve (12) days in a calendar year. No carried forward to the next calendar month and year for the unused entitlement.
- Minimum application day should be one (1) day. E.g. if employee applies menstruation leave in the afternoon, the leave application will be regarded as one (1) day application.
- The days of the leave application will be deducted from the accumulated sick leave entitlement of employee.
- The menstruation leave will not be compensated in salary or cash.

b) Application procedures

Employee should submit the application to their direct supervisor/ department head as earliest as possible. After the direct supervisor/ department head approves the application, he/she should forward the application to HR within the same day for the attendance record purpose. The leave application form should be submitted to the human resources office on the same or following business day. No medical certificate is required to submit.

12.12 Compensation Leave

Employee is generally not compensated for overtime or work voluntarily on a rest day. However, compensation leave or holiday pay will be granted, if employee is specially requested by the management to work on after normal duty hours, weekends and public holidays.

a) Entitlement

- i. Overtime work is the work undertaken beyond employee's normal office hours only for special duties (e.g. event, conference, training and etc.) or travel to overseas for work.
- ii. Overtime accumulated during the special events or travel should be compensated.
- iii. All time-off in lieu earned by eligible employee during a month can accumulate a maximum of 24 hours by the end of each month. Any untaken compensation leave (CL) beyond the maximum accumulation of twenty-four (24) hours at the month end will be lapsed unless the employment contract specified. Therefore, necessary arrangements shall be made by the relevant employee to avoid forfeiture.

Example:

Overtime in April	CL taken in April	CL balance – 1 May
25 hours	1 hour	24 hours
25 hours	0 hour	24 hours (1 hour lapsed)

- iv. If employee cannot clear the compensation leave (CL) by the end of the month to avoid the forfeiture, extension of the forfeiture deadline must be sought from CEO.
- v. Time spent for having meals which are not provided by the event organiser is not included in the overtime work.

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- vi. Overtime and time-off in lieu should have prior written approval by the department head and CEO.
- vii. A standard form is used for approval and record of overtime work and time-off in lieu.
- viii. Overtime is counted and rounded down to 0.5 hour for compensation by time-off in lieu.
- ix. All compensation leave balance will not be compensated in salary or cash.

b) Overtime Work due to Oversea Travel

- i. Overtime is counted with a maximum of 7.5 hours per day.
- ii. Overtime is counted in the below circumstances during non-office hour:
 - On Flight
 - For outbound trips, the time between arrival at the port of exit in Hong Kong and hotel check-in.
 - For return trips, the time between hotel check-out and arrival to home in Hong Kong.
 - If there is no duty performed on rest days, no CL shall be granted.

c) Overtime Work due to Local Events

- i. When employee participates in any event, which is held on Saturday, Sunday or public holidays, overtime is counted:
 - starting from when employee leaves home for work
 - until when employee arrives at home immediately after work
- ii. When employee participates in any event, which is held on outside normal duty hours on weekdays, overtime is counted:
 - starting from when employee leaves home for work
 - until when employee arrives at home immediately after work

12.13 Leave Application Arrangement

Unless specified in the above, all leave applications should be submitted for approval in the prescribed form at least one week prior to the intended leave taken day. The approved form should submit to HR at least 2 workings days prior to the leave taken day. Cancellation or modification of leave is subject to the prior approval of supervisor and department head, please inform human resources office about the change accordingly.

12.14 Leave without Notice

Any leave, other than the emergency sick leave, without prior notice and approval from the immediate supervisor will be regarded as leave without notice and is a behavior of work negligence. Habitual negligence of work will lead to summary dismissal or disciplinary punishment.

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13 Performance Management System (PMS)

13.1 Introduction

The performance management cycle is an annual process to promote communication and provide useful job performance feedback to employees. All employees go through this cycle, starting with objectives setting, followed by the monitoring of their progress, providing feedback to them to develop and perform better, and ending with a formal evaluation. Ongoing coaching is highly recommended to maintain quality performance.

13.2 Performance Management Cycle & Timeline

Performance management is an ongoing cycle starting from July to June each year. All full time employees (both permanent and contract) are required to participate in the performance appraisal, training & development review and next year performance objectives setting. There is no formal annual performance review for the part time staff. However, they are always expected to carry out their responsibilities in a diligent manner and their performance will be subject to regular reviews.

15 May – 30 Jun:	Review period
1 Jul – 31 Jul	CEO will review all PMS review reports so as to ensure fairness among different units in offering the ratings by each Unit Head
1 Aug :	Will return the PMS review to staff

13.3 Roles and Responsibilities

- a) The key parties involved are the subordinate (appraisee), direct supervisor (appraiser) and the reviewer (next level of supervisor).
- b) Appraisee should participate in the whole process with the understanding of his/her job duties, to provide feedbacks, collaboratively set performance objectives with supervisors and suggest training needs, etc.
- c) Appraiser would be a direct supervisor whom shall work closely with the appraisee, understand his/her job duties & requirements, set and examine performance objectives that aligned with the organisational goals, plan and provide appropriate training and development and to ensure confidentiality, integrity and equal opportunity among subordinates.
- d) The reviewer shall be at the next level of supervisor that is department head or CEO. He/she shall be an independent and integrity checker ensuring that the appraisal is properly completed.
- e) Appraiser and reviewer cannot be the same person if applicable.
- f) Human resources office is responsible for administering the whole performance review, providing communication and training to ensure staff members' understanding and strengthen its effectiveness, and providing recommendations for management on its implementation.

13.4 Performance Planning

Performance planning starts with a session between the appraiser and appraisee at the end of each appraisal year or the completion of probationary review to agree on the list of objectives/responsibilities for the coming appraisal period.

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13.5 Performance Rating Scale

Rating Category	Proficiency level in the rating		
A - Substantially exceed standard	15 scores	14 scores	13 scores
B - Consistently exceed standard	12 scores	11 scores	10 scores
C - Meet standard	9 scores	8 scores	7 scores
D - Partially meet standard	6 scores	5 scores	4 scores
E - Below standard	3 score	2 score	1 score

There will be “passed” or “failed” only for the performance evaluation of the “Child Safeguarding” competency. The passing mark is 8 scores, while the failed mark is 1 score. Employees should fulfil the below requirements for passing eligibility.

- Completed the two online courses of Child Safeguarding namely the “Safeguarding Essential” and “Keeping Children and Young People Safe in Plan International” or
- Completed the online course named “Safeguarding Essentials Refresher” and
- Demonstrated sufficient and appropriate sense and awareness on Child Safeguarding in the daily work.

13.6 Performance Appraisal

Notes to appraiser

- Appraiser should discuss with reviewer on preliminary basis before conducting a face-to-face discussion with the appraisee.
- Giving full account of achievements against performance objectives and the appraisee's performance.
- Achievement of performance objectives in Part A should account for 60%, whereas core competencies in Part B should account for 40% in the annual performance review.
- For Part A, remember to measure staff's efforts made for achieving plan that has been set as an ambitious one and/or a pilot one. Take external factors into account when and wherever appropriate.
- Give higher rating for extra stretching objectives.
- Please input the brief comments to each item in Part A, Part B and Part C (Areas of Improvement) accordingly. Please provide rating and complete the rating calculation after the performance review meeting. Please make sure the ratings and comment are mutually agreed with appraisee after the performance rating calibration review by CEO.
- All the ratings of staff members will be finalised after the performance rating calibration review to make sure fairness and accuracy, when ratings are awarded across departments of each employee.
- When changes of supervisor occur, the new supervisor should consult the previous supervisor for comments on staff work performance. Based upon the length of supervisory duration, the new and previous supervisors shall share the respective pro-rata responsibility in the performance appraisal ratings and development review process.

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Notes to appraisee

- a) Please use the annual performance review form for the performance review and are required to complete Part A, Part B and Part C. Please leave the two columns of “Rating” and “Weight * Rating” blank. The department head will complete these sections. For Part B, please give examples about the competencies demonstration.
- b) Please use the form of ‘Performance Plan and Objectives for Coming Year’ for the objectives setting for the coming appraisal period.

The forms of the PMS are available in the HR server.

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14 Training and Development

Education Sponsorship Programme

To encourage the training and development of employee, the Training Sponsorship Programme is established to offer financial assistance and study leave to employee for their competencies growth and career development by taking the internal and external learning opportunities.

14.1 Coverage

The programme covers the internal (organised by Plan International or Plan International Hong Kong) and external training and/ or award bearing or non-award bearing courses, conference or seminar pursued by employee during the office or non-office hours, which will benefit both the employee and organisation. Preference will be given to the courses, which meet the organisational needs, job duties and career development of employee.

14.2 Vetting Criteria

At the time of application, the employee should be on employment status and have completed at least 3 months of service in the organisation with satisfactory performance. The following vetting criteria will be adopted and considered:

- a) Relevance to the present job duties
- b) Relevance to the current and future needs of the department
- c) Relevance to the future need of PIHK
- d) Quality of the course
- e) Record of the previous support to the employee
- f) Availability of funds
- g) Performance and career development of the employee

14.3 General Guidelines

- a) All applications should be made at least 1 month prior to the course enrolment. Communication should be conducted between employee and supervisor/ department head/ CEO to ascertain, whether the course will meet the above vetting criteria. Employee who applies the education sponsorship programme after the course enrolment will be liable to the risk of non-approval.
- b) Employee should notify the Human Resources Office and the approval authority (e.g. CEO, department head or direct supervisor), if he/she is unable to enroll to the proposed course/ programme within three (3) months from the date of approval. Also, all approvals will be automatically lapsed, if the employee does not start the approved course(s) within 3 months after the approval has been sought.
- c) If the notice of withdrawal is submitted, employee is entitled to make another new application.

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- d) Employee is required to submit the original copy of the certificate after the course completion for reimbursement. If no certificate can be obtained after the course completion, employee should mention it on the application form and have the prior written approval by the department head and CEO.
- e) Employees should only claim the actual amount borne by them and if they have obtained the additional sponsorship from other funding source(s), such as the Continuing Education Fund (CEF), they should not have extra pecuniary advantage through these sponsorships.

- d) Education sponsorship will be awarded in the following ways

	Internal Training/ Conference/ Seminar	External Training/ Conference/ Seminar
Education sponsorship	- Study Leave (conduct during/ after the office hour)	- Study leave (conduct during the office hour) and/or - Fee reimbursement (full or partial)

14.4 Application Procedures

- a) Employee who wishes to apply for sponsorship should complete the application form, which is available in the HR server.
- b) Upon the receipt of the application, supervisor/ department Head or CEO are required to discuss and make recommendations with the subordinate about the application with due consideration to the manpower need, the approved staff development plan of the department / organisation, as well as the vetting criteria stated in the above.
- c) All applications have to be approved by both direct supervisor/ department head and CEO. The approved application will pass to human resources office for further processing.
- d) Re-application of a rejected course will not be entertained.

14.5 Reimbursement

- a) Employee who wish to claim reimbursement should submit the claim form named "Application for Reimbursement of Fees" (available in HR server) to the human resources office attaching:
 - i. Original of the fee receipt and;
 - ii. Original Copy of transcript / completion certificate etc., as appropriate.
- b) PIHK offers the support on reimbursement basis and there will be no advance payment. Full reimbursement of the approved amount will only be made upon successful completion of the course.
- c) Reimbursement will only be made if the applicant is still a serving employee and has not tendered notice of resignation at the time when the reimbursement is ready.
- d) Tuition / Course Fees is permitted for the reimbursement claim.

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- e) Claim for reimbursement of the following items will not be entertained:
- Application Fee
 - Caution Money
 - Graduation Fee
 - Membership Fee
 - Registration Fee
 - Students Fee
 - Text Book Fee
 - Examination Fee
 - Exemption Fee
 - Traveling & Menu Expenses
 - Reservation Fee
- f) Claims must be made before the end of the financial year in which the course is completed and no retrospective claim will be entertained, unless notice of accrual expenses has been made with the CEO office and finance department.

14.6 Commitment

Employee receiving financial support under the programme will normally be required to fulfill a service requirement; upon completion of the course (i.e. the completion date shown on the completion certificate). Period of commitment as follows is required for each of the financial support offered.

Amount Claimed	Commitment of Service
HK\$5000 or below	Nil
HK\$5,001 - HK\$10,000	2 months

Employee is required to reimburse Plan International Hong Kong for the total amount claimed for the programme under any one of the following circumstances (unless otherwise approved by CEO):

- iii. Failure to fulfill the service requirement as stipulated above;
- iv. Other situations where Plan International Hong Kong deems repayment to be appropriate.

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15 Policy on Code of Conduct

Professionalism, high ethical standards, integrity and honesty of employees are crucial in PIHK. The purpose of this code of conduct is to lay down the employees' obligations and the expected behavior standard, which they are required to comply with. This code of conduct also provides guidelines to assist employees in understanding and complying with such obligations. All employees are required to sign the "Staff Declaration Form" upon the commencement of employment to declare that they have read, understood and agreed to abide by the policies and procedures of Plan International that are in place from time to time.

For detailed, please refer to the policy named "Global Policy on Values, Conduct and Whistleblowing".

16 Policy on Harassment Bullying Discrimination

PIHK acts to ensure dignity at work. Harassment, Bullying and Discrimination are unacceptable. Complaints about discrimination or harassment will be taken seriously and will be handled promptly and in strictest confidence. For details, please refer to the policy named "Harassment, Bullying & Discrimination Policy".

17 Policy on Grievance

PIHK is committed to ensuring fair treatment of all employees when dealing with their grievances with a view to addressing problems in the best possible manner. For details, please refer to the policy named "Grievance Policy".

18 Policy on Disciplinary

In order to achieve and maintain efficient operational standards, it is essential that all employees in PIHK should comply with the acceptable standards of conduct. Disciplinary regulations are laid down with the objective of protecting the best interests of the organisation and its employees. For details, please refer to the policy named "Disciplinary Policy".

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19 Conflict of interest

19.1 Restrictions on employee's activities outside the organisation

- a) Employee must obtain the prior written approval of the organisation before engaging or taking up either on a regular or ad hoc basis, directly or indirectly, with or without remuneration in any business/ employment/ service outside the organisation. The approving authority will take into consideration, whether the business / employment / service would pose a conflict of interest with employee's duties in the organisation and reserve the absolute decision on the approval.
- b) In case the engagement at all time will/ may compete or conflict in any way with the business of the organisation or that is related to the services to be provided by the employee or the organisation, or may impair the performance of employee's duties, employee must declare and make full disclosure in writing to HR and CEO immediately.
- c) Employee must fully understand that should he/she be found violating this restriction, he/she will be liable to disciplinary action, including summary dismissal.
- d) The organisation reserves the right to make a report to the Independent Commission Against Corruption (ICAC) and/or other government bodies, if the breach of this restriction would constitute an offence under the Prevention of Bribery Ordinance or other related offences.

19.2 Gifts and sponsorship offered to staff policy

All employee must be wary of any "advantage" which is offered to him/her and which could in any way be connected with his/her duties in PIHK. Employee is prohibited to solicit or accept any advantages from any persons and in any format, unless permission has been received. For details, please refer to the policy named "Gifts and sponsorship offered to staff policy".

19.3 Declaration of interest

Employees are required to declare any matter in which a conflict of interest would likely occur as a result of their private investments/interests. This practice will be conducted annually for the manager grade (including Assistant Manager grade) or above staff. The other staff will be required to fill up the form of 'Declaration of Interest' upon the emergence of the needs. The form is available in the HR server.

All PIHK staff should declare, to the best of their knowledge, their interests in any matters of PIHK when they act on a decision-making process or in an advisory capacity. Any change of circumstances after the completion of this form should be reported in writing as soon as it is found practicable.

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20 Work Arrangements in times of Rainstorms & Typhoon Signals

20.1 Introduction

The Labour Department urged employers to devise work arrangements for staff in times of typhoons and rainstorms before the rainy and typhoon season arrives. PIHK adopts the Government's advice on having a rainstorm warning system and has developed the following guidelines. As it is not practical to cover every possible weather condition, we will take a flexible approach and will give due consideration to safety in the workplace, as well as to the journey to and from work.

20.2 Scope of Policy

This policy applies to all employees working at office of PIHK.

20.3 Policy Detail

a) Work Arrangement during typhoon

	Typhoon Warning Signal No. 1 & 3	Typhoon Warning Signal Pre-No 8/ No. 8 or above	Extreme Weather Condition
Typhoon Warning Signal is issued before normal working hours	All employees should report for duty as scheduled.	All employees are not required to report for duty.	
Typhoon Warning Signal is issued before normal working hours	N/A	All employees are not required to report for duty.	
Typhoon Warning Signal is issued during working hours	N/A	- All employees should be released. - Employee who may face greater hardships in travelling (including pregnant and physically handicapped employees and those live in remote areas, i.e. outlying islands) will be allowed to leave first as soon as practicable. Other employees will be released in stages according to their travelling distances or the time required returning home.	
If the Warning/Signal is lowered before 13:30	N/A	All employees should resume duty within 2 hours of the signal being lowered.	

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b) Work Arrangement during Rainstorm Warning

	Amber or Red Rainstorm Warning	Black Rainstorm Warning
The Warning is in force before normal working hours	All employees should report for duty as usual.	All employees are not required to report for duty.
The Warning is issued during working hours	Employees should continue their work in the office.	Employees should continue their work in the office unless it is dangerous to do so.
If the Warning is lowered before 13:30	N/A	All employees should resume duty within 2 hours of the signal being lowered.
If the Warning is in force by the end of working hour	Employees should be released as usual.	Employees should be released as usual. However, in case any employees choose to stay in the company premises due to bad weather, an area in the company premises should be made available as temporary shelter for employees until the heavy rain has passed.

20.4 General Points to Note

Employees should inform their supervisors / human resources office as soon as practicable, if they have difficulties in reporting for duty.

All employees should not work (including the online workshop/ training/ meeting) or travel to work when the bad weather signal is hoisted unless approval is sought from CEO.

The above arrangement is also applicable during the "Work from Home" period.

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21 Amendment of the Staff HR Manual

The organisation reserves the right to change, add, delete or discontinue any of the policies in this manual, as it deems appropriate. As circumstances change, new policies will be introduced and existing policies will be revised to reflect the changing needs of the organisation. The organisation will announce the latest policies, procedures, practices and regulations via e-mail

If there are any questions, employees may contact their supervisor or department head, CEO or human resource office for clarifications.

Approval

Effective Date:	Revision No.: N/A	Board Approval:
Review Period:	Established By: Agnes Wong and Kanie Siu	Approval Date: